At Messflix, you decide to follow the two primary goals we've presented. The first one provides a good base for a long-lasting data mesh effect, and the second makes the selection of technologies behind your central platform and data products easier.

3.3.1 Defining data mesh value statement(s)

The first goal of your governance body—defining value statements—is not technical; it is vital nevertheless. It not only sets the tone for the data mesh but also may bring new quality to data governance in your company even if you decide to pursue another approach.

What is a value statement? Many equally good definitions exist. However, for this exercise, we use the one describing a value statement as an assertion of causality between a business action and the resulting business value.

Robert S. Seiner, in *Non-Invasive Data Governance* (Technics Publications, 2014), presents a general structure of a value statement as follows:

> Organizations that [take some action] demonstrate [business value improvement].

What is the added value of a value statement? Isn't it just a buzzword? If done well, it isn't. It's the backbone for all the decision-making, to be referred to as context for what to do next. The value statement is supposed to be the final word when setting priorities.

You may ask, "Isn't it enough that we choose more efficient technical solutions? Why do we need to waste time discussing value statements?" You just made a value statement. Let's rephrase it:

> Companies that simply choose more-efficient technical solutions demonstrate less time wasted on buzzwords.

Wasn't that hard, was it?

However, in your MVP, you may want to test your value statement against business reality. Is the efficiency of IT solutions the most important value in your organization? Or maybe some efficiency can be sacrificed for the sake of user experience? Or sustainability? Or maintainability?